

Comparative Essay 1: Industry and Social Change

Due: Friday, October 16 at 11:59 PM

Value: 175 points

Format: 1,500-1,800 word comparative essay

Purpose

Develop a sustained comparison explaining why industrialization changed social relations differently in two settings.

Your task

- Choose two cases: Britain, Meiji Japan, colonial India, the Russian Empire, or the United States between 1780 and 1914.
- Answer: Which combination of state policy, labor systems, household strategies, and global markets best explains the most important similarity and difference between your cases?
- Use at least four primary sources, with at least two from each case, plus assigned scholarly readings.
- Organize paragraphs by analytical point of comparison, not one country followed by the other.
- Address one counterexample or group whose experience complicates your thesis.

Recommended workflow

- Working comparison matrix due in class October 7.
- Thesis workshop October 12.
- Optional draft conference slots October 13-15.

Submit

- 1,500-1,800 word essay PDF.
- Chicago footnotes and bibliography; bibliography excluded from word count.

Grading criteria

Criterion	Pts	Full-credit evidence
Comparative thesis	30	Makes a specific, arguable comparison that answers the prompt.
Historical evidence	45	Uses accurate, specific evidence from both cases and at least four primary sources.
Analysis	45	Explains similarity, difference, causation, and significance rather than listing facts.
Organization	25	Paragraphs develop the comparison directly with clear transitions.
Context and qualification	15	Situates both cases and addresses a limitation or counterexample.
Style and citation	15	Clear prose and complete Chicago-style citations and bibliography.

Submission standards

Upload a readable PDF unless the handout specifies another format. Include your name, course code, and assignment title. Cite borrowed ideas and retain the editable source file. The learning portal timestamp is the official submission time.